

Community Building Partnership 2026

Program Guidelines

April 2026





Acknowledgement of Country

The NSW Premier's Department acknowledges the Traditional Custodians of the lands where we work and live. We celebrate the diversity of Aboriginal peoples and their ongoing cultures and connections to the lands and waters of NSW.

Grant program details

Expression of interest (EOI) opening	Monday 20 April 2026
EOI closing	Friday 8 May 2026 (5 pm AEST sharp)
Notification of shortlisted EOIs	Friday 26 June 2026
Detailed Application opening	Monday 29 June 2026
Detailed Application closing	Friday 17 July 2026
Application outcome date (anticipated)	Friday 22 January 2027
Project completion date	Monday 24 January 2028
Evaluation (for successful applicants)	Successful applicants may be required to participate in a program evaluation after the project has commenced. The evaluation may require applicants to provide evidence of how the project has resulted in measurable benefits consistent with the objectives of the program.
Decision-maker	Premier or their delegate
NSW Government agency	Premier's Department Department of Communities and Justice
Type of grant opportunity	Open, competitive
Grant value	Total funding: • Up to \$41.85 million • Up to \$450,000 for each NSW electoral district Individual grant amounts: • \$10,000 to \$100,000
Enquiries	Email: cbp2026@dcj.nsw.gov.au Phone: 02 8753 8144

The Premier's Department reserves the right to amend any of these dates during the program, at its absolute discretion.

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Introduction



1. Introduction

1.1 Overview of grant program

The Community Building Partnership (CBP) program provides grant funding to local community organisations and councils to strengthen the wellbeing of NSW communities through small local infrastructure projects. Since 2009, the program has awarded more than \$505 million to over 22,400 community infrastructure projects.

Total funding available for the CBP round in 2026 is **\$41.85 million**. Grants can be sought for amounts ranging from **\$10,000** to **\$100,000**.

There is a maximum of **\$450,000** grant funding available in each electoral district.

Eligible applicants include a wide range of community-based organisations and local councils.

Eligible projects are broken down into 3 categories:

- deliver **capital works** to upgrade existing and/or construct new community infrastructure
 - purchase **freestanding equipment** to support the delivery of community services
 - purchase **registered vehicles** to support the delivery of community services.
-

1.2 New for CBP 2026

CBP 2026 has a new 2-stage application process:

1. Expression of Interest (EOI) from all interested organisations and councils

- Eligible organisations can submit up to 2 EOIs for each electoral district. Organisations must read the eligibility criteria requirements before deciding whether to submit an EOI.
- EOIs will include a short project description of what the project will purchase, who will it benefit, how it aligns with the electoral district priorities (see *Electoral district priorities*), project location, conflict of interest information and organisation details.
- Members of Parliament (MPs) will, at their discretion, shortlist EOIs that, in their opinion, represent a mix of projects that meet the electoral district priorities.
- Applicants of shortlisted EOIs will be invited to submit a Detailed Application.

2. Detailed Application by shortlisted applicants notified after EOI

- Detailed Applications will be assessed by assessors for organisation and project eligibility.
- Eligible applications will be assessed by assessors against the merit assessment criteria.
- The Premier's Department will consult with MPs on the final list of applications in an electoral district to be recommended for approval.
- The Premier's Department will make the funding recommendations, which will be submitted to the Decision-maker for consideration.

Please note: Eligibility will not be assessed until after the Detailed Application is submitted. Therefore, if an organisation is shortlisted from the EOI stage and invited to submit a Detailed Application, this does not guarantee or imply acceptance of eligibility. A shortlisted organisation may be determined to be ineligible during the Detailed Application stage.

Electoral district-specific program

In 2026, a separate program has been established in SmartyGrants for each electoral district. Applicants must visit the [CBP home page](#) on SmartyGrants and identify the correct electoral district before starting their EOI.

Electoral district priorities

MPs will outline priority needs for their electoral district that the funding program aims to address.

You can view the priorities for each electoral district for the CBP 2026 round, as described by the relevant MP, online and in the EOI form.

Electoral district priorities have been identified by MPs drawing on their knowledge of the community, and are informed by a range of factors such as demographic data, socio-economic indicators, health and wellbeing measures, safety and environmental considerations, geographical distribution, equity and inclusion, gaps in community infrastructure, relevant research and surveys, community consultation, and other local data sources.

MPs may also use their direct understanding of the electoral district to ensure that selected priorities reflect both evidence and lived experience within the community.

When EOIs are received, they will be reviewed and shortlisted by the MP at their discretion, based on how well each project addresses the priorities. This will ensure funded projects are targeted to meet the specific needs of each electoral district.

1.3 Purpose of this document

These guidelines outline the funding rules for the administration of the CBP 2026 program, including eligibility criteria, assessment and approval process, key timeframes and the allocation of funding to successful grant applicants.

Applicants must read this document before lodging an EOI or a subsequent Detailed Application.

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Application process



2. Application process

2.1 Expression of interest (EOI)

Any eligible applicant can submit an EOI that includes a summary of the project, who the project will benefit, project location and applicant organisation details.

You can view the priorities for each electoral district for the CBP 2026 round, as described by the relevant MP, and download a PDF copy of the form from SmartyGrants if you would first like to prepare your EOI offline.

Each EOI must include only:

- one project location
- one project category
- one funding approach.

You must submit a complete EOI for the electoral district that relates to your project location. If you submit an incomplete EOI, your EOI will not progress to shortlisting.

You can select your electoral district from the list of programs on the SmartyGrants [CBP home page](#) (for example: Albury – CBP 2026).

For vehicle projects, your project location must identify the electoral district that the vehicle will primarily service, and the address where the vehicle will be registered.

Each applicant is limited to submitting 2 EOIs per electoral district.

To apply for both full and partial funding of your project, please submit a separate EOI for each funding option. EOIs with a contribution to the funding required are encouraged. If an applicant applies for full funding in one EOI and partial funding in another EOI for the same project, these EOIs for the same project will only count as 1 towards the 2 EOI limit in that electoral district.

Lodge an EOI at the SmartyGrants [CBP home page](#) by selecting your electoral district. EOIs must be submitted on or before Friday 8 May 2026 (5 pm AEST sharp).

Shortlisting of EOIs

When EOIs are received, the local MP will shortlist EOIs that, in their opinion, represent a mix of projects that meet the electoral district priorities. Shortlisting is based on the pre-identified priorities for each electoral district and the discretion of the local MP. MPs will be able to consider the organisation details, project title, project category, project location, project description, funding request, description of how the project aligns with the electoral district priorities, as well as any declarations of conflicts of interest submitted by the organisation.

This step ensures that CBP 2026 remains responsive to local needs and that funding decisions are informed by both data and community insight.

MPs may identify opportunities to fund applications from multiple electoral district allocations (joint funding) during the shortlisting process. Joining funding applications across electoral districts is allowed where all MPs have agreed through their own arrangements. MPs will be responsible for negotiating funding allocations with any other MPs involved during the shortlisting process.

MPs must declare any known interests they have with an organisation or council at the time of shortlisting. Where a high probity concern is identified, an Independent Shortlist Reviewer (a public servant) will determine if the EOI aligns with the electoral district's priorities.

If shortlisted, the applicant will be invited to submit a Detailed Application.

Only complete EOIs submitted via the SmartyGrants online grant portal will be considered by the MP for shortlisting. To submit an EOI form, the applicant must:

- complete and submit the EOI form in SmartyGrants by Friday 8 May 2026 (5 pm AEST sharp)
- confirm that the organisation is eligible
- confirm that the project is eligible
- confirm that you have all necessary supporting documentation to deliver the project
- confirm that you can deliver the project by 24 January 2028
- confirm that you can submit a Detailed Application by Friday 17 July 2026
- have your form signed and endorsed by an authorised person within your organisation
- ensure your EOI form is submitted by the closing date and time. No late EOIs will be accepted.

Notification of EOI outcome

If your EOI is shortlisted, you will be invited to submit a Detailed Application.

If your EOI is not shortlisted, your application for grant funding will not proceed. Unsuccessful applicants will be notified by email at the same time as shortlisted applicants are invited to submit a Detailed Application.

How to lodge a Detailed Application

Applicants who receive an invitation to submit a Detailed Application can download a PDF copy of the Detailed Application form from SmartyGrants if they would first like to prepare their application offline.

Read through the form thoroughly and make sure you complete each section. Remember to save your application regularly to avoid losing valuable content. Upload all the required supporting documentation before you submit your form.

CBP 2026 Detailed Applications must be submitted on or before **Friday 17 July 2026 (5 pm AEST sharp)**

- Applications can be submitted at any time before the deadline, but will not be accepted after Friday 17 July 2026 (5 pm AEST sharp).
- Applications will be assessed from 20 July 2026.
- Approvals will be announced by 22 January 2027 (anticipated).

Important notes

- Your application must be accurate and complete upon submission.
- Applicants will not be permitted to re-open or add further information to their application after it has been submitted.
- Submission of an application does not guarantee funding.
- The cost of preparing an application is the responsibility of the applicant.
- The declaration section of the application must be authorised by:
 - a member of the executive or committee as deemed under your organisation's constitution, or
 - by the General Manager or delegated officer where a local council is submitting the application.

Supporting documentation

- All supporting documentation referenced below must be provided as part of your application.

All applicants must submit:

- a detailed and itemised project budget for the full requested amount
- valid and current Certificate of Currency for Public Liability Insurance with a minimum cover of \$5 million.

For capital works projects where Development Approval (DA) is required, applicants must submit evidence of a DA.

Evidence that WILL be accepted includes:

- current valid notice of determination showing consent has been granted
- complying development and/or construction certificate.

Evidence that WILL NOT be accepted includes:

- planning or zoning certificate
- receipt for lodgement of a Development Application
- any document that does not clearly demonstrate DA by a consent authority.

For capital works projects where property/landowner's consent for the works to be undertaken at the project location is required, applicants must submit property/landowner's consent, including one of the following:

- a CBP Property/Landowner's Consent form, completed by the owner of the buildings/land or Crown land manager
- a letter providing full consent from the owner or Crown Land manager for works to commence
- for projects on Crown lands only, confirmation from the applicant that the proposed works fit within the parameters of 'deemed consent' as defined in section 2.23 of the *Crown Land Management Act 2016*
- for projects on Department of Education land only, a PDF print-out of the Asset Management Unit (AMU) approval as it appears in the Department's Facilities Management portal (FM portal).

For projects that request \$30,001 or above, applicants must submit quotes to verify project expenditure, which align with the information provided in your project budget.

Evidence that WILL NOT be accepted includes:

- invoices, project cost sheets, opinion on a probable cost or pre-tender estimate summaries
- quotes dated more than 6 months before the application date.

Quotes for applications that request \$30,000 or less are preferred, but not mandatory.

3

Selection criteria



3. Selection criteria

3.1 Eligibility criteria

To be considered eligible, applications must be submitted through the online system SmartyGrants.

Eligible applicants

To be eligible to apply for funding, applicants must be one of the following organisation types:

- incorporated association registered with NSW Fair Trading
- Australian public company limited by guarantee
- Local Aboriginal Land Council
- Indigenous corporation registered with the Office of the Registrar of Indigenous Corporations
- NSW local council
- council committee under section 355 of the *Local Government Act 1993*
- trust registered with the Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission (ACNC)
- P&C Association registered by NSW Fair Trading
- P&C Association registered by the Federation of Parents and Citizens Associations of NSW
- not-for-profit entity incorporated under an Act of Parliament
- non-distributing co-operative registered with NSW Fair Trading.

Eligible applicants must also hold a valid and current Certificate of Currency for Public Liability Insurance with a minimum cover of \$5 million.

Ineligible applicants

The following types of applicants are not eligible to apply:

- organisations that are not incorporated
- for-profit organisations
- individuals
- political parties and associated entities
- NSW Government or Australian Government departments and agencies.

Examples of eligible and ineligible applicants

The table below provides examples of applicants that may be eligible or ineligible for CBP funding. This is not an exhaustive list of eligible and ineligible applicants. It is designed to give applicants an idea of the type of applicants that may be eligible or ineligible to apply for CBP funding.

Examples of applicants	Eligibility
Community group incorporated as a NSW Association – e.g. sporting body, multicultural group, community shed	Eligible
Community group registered as a NSW Co-operative – e.g. country club, childcare co-op, golf club	Eligible
Parents and Citizens Association (P&C Association) incorporated with the Federation of Parents & Citizens Associations of NSW under the <i>Parents & Citizens Association Act of 1976</i> No 50	Eligible
Aboriginal organisation registered by the Office of the Registrar of Indigenous Corporations (ORIC) – e.g. preschool, health and welfare corporation	Eligible
Public companies limited by guarantee	Eligible
Proprietary companies and companies limited by shares	Ineligible
Individuals or groups of individuals	Ineligible
Unincorporated organisations	Ineligible
For-profit commercial organisations	Ineligible
Organisations with unacquitted CBP projects (unless they have an active and approved extension in place to complete the project)	Ineligible
NSW Government or Australian Government agencies and their entities (including NSW Government schools, local health districts, and public hospitals) <i>These organisations should consider whether there is an incorporated not-for-profit body, such as a P&C Association, hospital auxiliary or incorporated entity that uses Crown Land facilities that may be eligible to apply for funding</i>	Ineligible
An eligible organisation applying on behalf of another eligible organisation	Ineligible

Eligible projects

Eligible projects must be able to meet the following criteria:

- be delivered in the NSW electoral district for which funding is sought
- be fully delivered by 24 January 2028.

CBP will consider applications between \$10,000 and \$100,000 for 3 categories:

1. Capital works

Capital works are defined as ‘improvements to the land or building, or freestanding equipment that will be fixed or installed to the land or building’. This includes:

- construction of new community infrastructure
- upgrade (refurbishment, repair and maintenance) to existing community infrastructure
- any project component that requires fixed installation and would require permission from the owner of the building/land to commence works. This applies even if your organisation is the owner and/or other project components are freestanding equipment.

2. Equipment

Equipment is defined as ‘freestanding equipment that does not require fixed installation and/or registration’. This includes:

- vehicles that do **not** require registration, e.g. tractors, utility task vehicles (UTVs), all-terrain vehicles (ATVs), dragon boats, golf buggies, dinghies, powerboats or sailing boats less than 5.5 m long or with an engine less than 4.0 kW
- Automated External Defibrillators (AEDs). Applications are limited to one package up to \$3,000 per application, per project location, and will be deemed ineligible if it is for more than one AED package at one project location.

3. Vehicles

Vehicles are defined as ‘vehicles that require registration’. This includes:

- purchase or modification of vehicles that require registration
- on-road vehicles such as cars, buses, trucks, and trailers
- off-road or on-water vehicles such as motorised rescue vehicles and boats.

Please note: If your project involves works that could fall into different categories (for example, both purchase of a vehicle and capital works), you will need to complete separate applications. You will only be able to select one category for each application.

Please note: If you have submitted an EOI for an electoral district that does not align with your project location, your application may be deemed ineligible.

Please note: Local councils and their committees under section 355 of the *Local Government Act 1993* are required to provide matched funding to the CBP grant amount awarded.

Please note: Applicants that have previously received a grant/s through the CBP 2022 and CBP 2023 rounds must have acquitted their previous projects, unless they have an active and approved extension in place.

Ineligible projects

The following types of projects are not eligible for funding under the CBP 2026 program:

- projects that have already commenced or are completed (retrospective funding)
- projects that exclusively benefit the applicant and its staff, such as internal capability building activities
- projects that are the responsibility of government agencies
- projects outside of NSW
- purchase of land or buildings
- housing-related costs, including renovations or construction of residential properties
- purchase of office equipment, tents, IT equipment or other non-fixed equipment not aligned with the program’s objectives
- gifts, including gift cards and merchandise intended for distribution as gifts
- purchase of alcohol
- private events or activities that are not open to the broader community
- operating and administrative costs such as rent, utilities, and ongoing operational expenses
- costs not directly associated with the delivery of the project
- projects that were not shortlisted.

Examples of eligible and ineligible projects

The table below provides examples of projects that may be eligible or ineligible for CBP funding. This is not an exhaustive list of eligible and ineligible projects. It is designed to give applicants an idea of the type of projects that may be eligible or ineligible to apply for CBP funding.

Examples of project types	Eligibility
Resurfacing of sporting courts – e.g. tennis, netball and basketball court upgrades, drainage, playground equipment installation	Eligible
Installation of shade structures – e.g. covered outdoor learning area or refurbishment to courtyard to make an ‘all weather’ area (<i>development approval or exemption may be required</i>)	Eligible
Restoration of building – e.g. restoration of stained-glass windows, roof repair, solar panel installation (<i>owner’s consent for Crown Land, development approval and heritage requirements may apply</i>)	Eligible
Accessibility improvement – e.g. amenities, kerb ramp	Eligible
Kitchen upgrade – e.g. clubhouse kitchen renovation, plumbing, electrical works, purchase of appliances	Eligible
Public announcement system – e.g. purchase of sound equipment, electrical works and installation	Eligible
Projects that have commenced works prior to the grant round closing date	Ineligible
Projects located outside of NSW	Ineligible
Projects that seek funding to: • run workshops, training or facilitation • stage events or exhibit displays • undertake filming or recording • cover operating costs or recurrent expenses such as staff costs, insurance, leases, bills, clothing, consumables, and disposables • deliver programs or services • undertake studies or investigations • purchase land or buildings (fixed assets)	Ineligible
Projects that involve the development of private or commercial ventures, including upgrades/works in licensed areas of registered clubs such as liquor and/or gaming areas	Ineligible
Projects receiving funding from other grant programs for the same scope of works	Ineligible
Projects that should be funded as a core responsibility from another source, such as a local government, the NSW Government or Australian Government	Ineligible
Project works or costs that have been or will be covered by insurance claims (e.g. repairs following weather events)	Ineligible
Applications submitted after the application closing date	Ineligible
Joint application or application submitted on behalf of an auspice organisation	Ineligible
Projects seeking funding exclusively for costs associated with planning, or a development approval application	Ineligible

Examples of project types	Eligibility
Applications without evidence of development approval, where required	Ineligible
Applications that request \$30,001 or above without quotation/s	Ineligible
Applications without a detailed and itemised project budget for full requested amount	Ineligible
Applicants that apply for an Automated External Defibrillators (AED) package above \$3,000	Ineligible
Applications requesting funding to purchase vehicle(s) that will not be registered under the applicant's name – e.g. a P&C Association applying for a bus that would be registered under the Department of Education	Ineligible

3.2 Detailed application merit assessment criteria

Each eligible application will be assessed based on whether the project has merit or does not have merit, focusing on the project's ability to strengthen community wellbeing, deliver value for money, and the applicant's capacity to deliver the project.

Detailed application criteria	How to address this criterion in your application
Criterion 1: Strengthen community wellbeing by delivering local infrastructure that will facilitate: - vibrant and active communities - sustainable and resilient communities and/or - inclusive and accessible communities.	Describe how your project will strengthen community wellbeing. Describe the benefits the project is expected to achieve. Explain the intended outcomes of your project and how they will enhance current activities and services in your community. Specify the groups within your community that will benefit from the project. Tell us how you know that the project will strengthen community wellbeing (including any evidence such as feedback, statistics, surveys and research, if available).
Criterion 2: Deliver value for money: How the project will deliver value for money in regard to the costs of the project and the community outcomes it will achieve.	Provide a detailed breakdown of all project costs and explain how each will be funded. Provide quotations, price comparisons or advice from professionals to show that the costs are reasonable. Provide letters confirming other sources of financial support.
Criterion 3: The organisation's capacity: The applicant has the capacity to deliver the project on time and within scope.	Tell us about the resources and skills within the organisation, or through a partnership, that will help it to successfully deliver the project on time and within budget. Detail your organisation's experience in delivering any similar projects. (For example, have you been successful in receiving grant funding previously and did you deliver the project on time?) Demonstrate that your organisation understands what it takes to deliver the project on time by including relevant project planning documentation in your application.

4

Detailed application assessment process



4. Detailed application assessment process

4.1 Assessment of applications

The assessment process is competitive, and funds are limited. The department will first review your application against the eligibility criteria. If eligible, your application will progress to the merit assessment.

Where an applicant has submitted multiple applications, each application will be assessed individually.

Eligibility assessment

Two assessors will each conduct an assessment to determine:

- the organisation is an **eligible applicant**
- the **project is eligible**
- the **correct NSW electoral district** is identified
- the **application meets program requirements** for commencement, completion and amount of funding requested
- information provided is **accurate and complete**.

If there are eligibility concerns identified as part of the eligibility assessment, the applicant will be provided with an opportunity to remedy their application to meet eligibility requirements.

Where one assessor determines a project is not eligible, it will be reviewed by the CBP Program Office, Premier's Department, to make a final determination.

Merit assessment

If assessed as eligible, 2 merit assessors will each undertake an assessment to determine the merit of the project, focusing on the project's ability to strengthen community wellbeing, deliver value for money, and the applicant's capacity to deliver the project.

Assessors will independently assess the project against each of the 3 merit assessment criteria (section 3.2), as 'meets', 'partially meets', or 'does not meet'.

Assessments from each assessor will be collated to create a 'combined assessment' for each criterion.

An overall merit assessment will then be assigned to the application:

- To be assessed as having **merit**, an application must be rated 'meets' on all 3 criteria.
- An application will be assessed as having **partial merit** if it does not meet the threshold for 'merit' but is rated as 'meets' or 'partially meets' on all 3 criteria.
- Any application rated as 'does not meet' on any criterion will be assessed as having **no merit**.

The merit assessment will inform the electoral district alignment review and funding recommendations.

Electoral district alignment review

The CBP Program Office will undertake an electoral district alignment review in partnership with the local MP to review the merit assessment and inform the funding recommendations for each electoral district.

The electoral district alignment review may consider any of the following:

- **overall merit assessment outcome:** the overall merit assessment assigned to the application (the primary evidence for determining whether or not an application is recommended)
- **electoral district priorities:** how well the project aligns with the electoral district priorities identified by the MP
- **geographical spread:** ensuring a reasonable distribution of funded projects across different areas within the electoral district
- **project types:** funding a variety of project types to deliver benefits to different cohorts within the community
- **project characteristics:** whether funding is already allocated to projects addressing the same priority need
- **other applications:** whether the applicant has made other applications for funding in the entire program and the amount of funding sought
- **funding history:** an applicant's track record in previous CBP program rounds, including whether they have been successful, and demonstrated capacity to deliver previously approved projects (for example, to ensure equitable distribution of funds)
- **maximising allocated funding:** funding a mix of applications to maximise the use of allocated funding, ensuring as much of the allocated funding as possible is allocated to approved projects in the electoral district.

MPs' input on joint funding recommendations will be considered as part of the Electoral District Alignment Review step.

Advice from the MP will inform the list of applications to be recommended to the Decision-maker and will be documented in accordance with section 6.3.3 of the *Grants Administration Guide*. The rationale for a funding recommendation will also be documented as part of the electoral district alignment review. Generally, MPs' advice will be given strong weight in considering the recommendations to be made to the Decision-maker, except where an MP's advice is not sought due to the application receiving a 'no merit' assessment outcome or due to a conflict of interest that cannot be appropriately managed.

Please note: The electoral district alignment process may result in applications with a 'partial merit' assessment outcome being funded ahead of applications assessed as 'has merit' where one or more of the considerations outlined above have been applied.

Funding recommendations

Following the electoral district alignment review, the CBP Program Office, Premier's Department will prepare funding recommendations for consideration by the Decision-maker, including documentation of input from MPs, and their consideration in the assessment process.

Recommendations will be for the funding amount nominated in the application.

Funding recommendations will be capped at the available amount for each electoral district.

Residual funds will be unspent and will not be carried over to another round.

Approval

The merit assessments, record of the electoral district alignment review process and funding recommendations for projects in each electoral district will be submitted to the Decision-maker for consideration and approval (along with other information required to be provided in writing to the Decision-maker under section 6.3.1 of the *Grants Administration Guide*).

Probity advice

The Cabinet Office provided guidance on issues concerning integrity, fairness and accountability that may arise throughout the application, assessment and decision-making process outlined in these Program Guidelines. An independent probity adviser has been engaged to provide external probity services for conflict of interest and issues management. These arrangements will ensure decisions are made with integrity, fairness and accountability, while delivering value for money for NSW.

4.2 Notification of application outcome

Successful and unsuccessful applicants will be notified in writing. Applicants may be requested to keep the grant confidential for a period until it is announced by the NSW Government.

Feedback on applications and appeal process

Grant decisions are final. There are no appeals under the CBP program. Any feedback about the program or individual applications should be submitted in writing to cbp2026@dcj.nsw.gov.au.

4.3 Publication of grants information

Successful projects will be published on the NSW Government Grants and Funding Finder website: nsw.gov.au/grants-and-funding, within a specified timeframe. This will include the name of the recipient organisation, the project title, a brief description of the project, and the grant amount.

5

Successful grant applications



5. Successful grant applications

Successful applicants must comply with the below program requirements. Failure to comply may result in the rescission of your grant offer.

5.1 Grant agreement

Successful applicants will be required to accept the CBP program's terms and conditions, which includes executing a Funding Agreement with the Department of Communities and Justice.

Successful applicants need to sign an online Funding Agreement. It is your responsibility to:

- carefully read the terms and conditions of the Funding Agreement
- sign and submit the Funding Agreement online by the due date provided.

You can view an [example of a Funding Agreement](#). The CBP team will review and countersign your Funding Agreement.

5.2 Grant payment

Successful applicants also need to submit an EFT Banking Details form. It is your responsibility to:

- provide the correct banking details before submitting the online form. Funds transferred to an incorrect bank account may not be recoverable
- provide the correct details, including email address of the signatories authorised to sign the Funding Agreement, without which the authorised signatories will not receive the Funding Agreement and funding cannot be released
- submit the EFT Banking Details form by the due date provided.

Once approved, we will pay your grant by electronic funds transfer (EFT).

5.3 Keeping your contact details up to date in SmartyGrants

It is the responsibility of the grant recipient to keep the CBP team up to date with any change in contact information. If the SmartyGrants user account contact details change, please email cbp2026@dcj.nsw.gov.au to update your contact details.

5.4 Purpose of CBP funds

CBP funding is provided to benefit local communities through the provision of local infrastructure. To ensure this purpose is upheld, the following applies:

- **Prohibited actions:** The sale, conversion, or other disposal of facilities or capital equipment funded through the CBP program is not permitted, as it conflicts with program objectives.
- **Repayment requirements:** If CBP-funded works are sold, converted, or otherwise disposed of within 2 years of project completion, the Department of Communities and Justice may require repayment of the CBP funding. This will be determined at the Department's discretion.
- **Notification requirement:** Recipients must notify the Department of Communities and Justice of any intended sale, conversion, or disposal of capital equipment or infrastructure funded by the CBP program.

5.5 Unspent funds

Successful applicants will be required to return unspent grant funds, or any grant funds not spent in accordance with the Funding Agreement.

5.6 Project variations

If you want to request a minor change, you must make a formal request via SmartyGrants and obtain a Deed of Variation. You must make this formal request before any related work takes place. If you do not make a formal variation request via SmartyGrants, your grant offer may be rescinded.

Any variation that substantively impacts the approved project will be treated as a new grant and will not be approved. Organisations will have the opportunity to apply for new funding in the next funding round, and these applications will be considered in line with the requirements of the NSW Government *Grants Administration Guide* and under the program guidelines of the current round.

If you would like to discuss a variation request, please call the CBP team on 02 8753 8144 or email cbp2026@dcj.nsw.gov.au. You will be required to provide documents to support your request.

5.7 Indicative reporting and acquittal requirements

All CBP 2026 projects must be completed before 24 January 2028. You are required to submit a Completion Report in SmartyGrants no later than 25 February 2028.

Successful applicants should familiarise themselves with the [evidence required for CBP grant acquittal](#).

It is a program requirement that all financial records related to grant expenditure and acquittal be retained by the committee of the organisation for 5 years. If the committee changes, these documents must be forwarded to the new incoming committee.

All applications are assessed on their own merits and each project must be delivered and acquitted in its own right. Waiting for potential future funding for a subsequent stage of works is not an acceptable rationale for delaying submission of progress or completion reporting for projects in previous funding rounds.

5.8 Program evaluation

As a condition of the grant, successful applicants may be required to participate in a program evaluation after the project has commenced. The evaluation may require applicants to provide evidence of how projects have resulted in measurable benefits consistent with the objectives of CBP.

6

Additional information and resources



6. Additional information and resources

6.1 Complaint handling

Any concerns about the program or individual applications should be submitted in writing to cbp2026@dcj.nsw.gov.au.

6.2 Access to information

The *Government Information (Public Access) Act 2009* (GIPA Act) provides for the proactive release of government information by agencies and gives members of the public an enforceable right to access government information held by an agency (which includes Ministerial offices). Access to government information is only to be restricted if there is an overriding public interest against disclosure.

The Houses of the NSW Parliament have the power to order the production of State papers by the Executive Government. For example, Standing Order 52 of the Legislative Council provides that the House may order documents to be tabled by the Government in the House. The Cabinet Office coordinates the preparation of the papers – that is, the return to order. The return to order may contain privileged and public documents. Privileged documents are available only to members of the Legislative Council.

Note that documents submitted as part of a grant application may be subject to an application under the GIPA Act or a parliamentary order for papers.

More information can be found on the websites of the [Premier's Department](#) and [Department of Communities and Justice](#).

6.3 Ethical conduct

Applicant's declaration

The declaration section of the application must be authorised:

- by a member of the executive or committee as deemed under the constitution of the applicant organisation, or
- by the General Manager or delegated officer where a local council is submitting the application.

This means the applicant must:

- certify that the application is truthful
- agree that the Premier's Department (or its delegated agents) may disclose information contained in the application to other government agencies, local government authorities, reviewers and staff assisting with the administration or promotion of other state government grant schemes.

Conflict of interest management

All applicants must declare if they, or key members of the organisation, are aware of anything that may cause the relevant MP to have an actual, perceived or potential conflict of interest when deciding whether or not to support the application.

Providing information about grounds for a conflict of interest may not affect a project's eligibility to receive grant funding under the CBP program. As MPs are involved in the shortlisting of EOIs and electoral district alignment review, it is important that all information about possible conflicts is recorded.

Where a conflict of interest is identified, the CBP Program Office will be responsible for seeking advice from the independent Probity Adviser and implementing appropriate management actions.

Examples of actual, perceived or potential conflicts of interest may include:

- financial interests, such as where the MP or a member of the MP's family is a shareholder or member of the applicant's organisation, or is a landlord of the applicant's premises
- where the MP or a member of the MP's family is a member of the applicant's governing board or committee
- where a member of the MP's family is enrolled at the applicant school, or is a member of the applicant sporting club or religious organisation
- where the MP or their spouse owns property that will be directly impacted (negatively or positively) by a project
- where key members of the applicant organisation have worked with the MP on a local political or election campaign
- any other relationship that the applicant or members of the applicant's organisation have with the MP, or have had in the past, which might appear to a reasonable bystander to have the capacity to influence the MP's feedback.

Confidentiality

Information received in submissions and in respect of submissions is treated as confidential. However, documents in the possession of the Department of Communities and Justice and the Premier's Department are subject to the provisions of the GIPA Act.

In order to adequately assess submissions for funding and implement the funding program, information contained in submissions will be shared with MPs, delegated officers and other government agencies, should it be deemed appropriate.

Should your application be successful, the Department of Communities and Justice or the Premier's Department will provide certain information to MPs and the media for promotional purposes. This information may include applicant name, project name, project description, location of the project, location of the grant recipient and amount funded, information provided in the grant application and project completion reports to develop case studies, including photos. The contact details supplied by the person submitting the application may also be provided to MPs. After notification of application outcome, applicants may be requested to keep the grant confidential until the announcement by the NSW Government.

Department's reserved rights

The Premier's Department or the Department of Communities and Justice may, in its absolute discretion, and without limiting any other right which the Premier's Department or Department of Communities and Justice may have, do all or any of the following at any time without giving notice or reasons:

- require additional information from an applicant
- change any of the requirements of these Program Guidelines
- alter or vary any process, procedure or timing related to the grant opportunity, including any process, procedure or timing regarding the consideration or the assessment of any or all applications
- suspend or terminate the grant opportunity
- negotiate with one or more applicants without prior notice to any other applicant
- terminate any negotiations being conducted with any applicant
- readvertise for new applicants
- consider any ineligible application

- terminate further participation in the grant opportunity by any applicant for any reason (including if the Premier's Department or Department of Communities and Justice reasonably considers an application to contain any false or misleading claims or statements)
- not proceed with any Funding Agreement or proceed with a Funding Agreement in ways not contemplated in these Program Guidelines.

Premier's Department

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More information

nsw.gov.au/departments-and-agencies/premiers-department

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